Practical 1: Generate a First RetailPulse Report

Related topic: Introduction to IBM Cognos Analytics - Reporting

Name: Akshat Sahu | **Date performed:** 08 October 2026

BCA (DS & AI) | School of Computer Applications, Babu Banarasi Das University | 2026-2027

Objective

Navigate the Cognos Analytics Reporting environment and generate a running list report against the RetailPulse Sales package.

Materials Required

IBM Cognos Analytics access, RetailPulse Sales package, a personal content folder to save into.

Step-by-Step Procedure

1. Open IBM Cognos Analytics and select **New > Report** from the welcome screen.
The Report authoring studio opens with the package picker.

2. Choose the **RetailPulse Sales** package as the data source when prompted.
Source tab now lists the package namespace (Region, Product Category, Sales Amount, etc.).

3. Pick the **List** template from the template gallery to start with a simple layout.
An empty list object appears on the page canvas.

4. From the **Source** tab, drag **Region**, **Product Category** and **Sales Amount** onto the canvas.
Columns drop into the list in the order dragged; headings are taken from the package labels.

5. Click **Run** in the toolbar (Run HTML) to generate the report and preview live RetailPulse data.
Cognos executes the query; rows replace the placeholder text.

6. Save as "RetailPulse - First Sales Report" in **My content** (personal folder), then close and reopen it from My content to confirm.

Sample Solution (Output)

RetailPulse - First Sales Report

Region	Product Category	Sales Amount
North	Electronics	$11,222.87
North	Apparel	$14,294.25
North	Home & Kitchen	$12,080.67
South	Electronics	$14,745.91
South	Apparel	$13,944.42
South	Home & Kitchen	$12,325.25
East	Electronics	$14,175.29
East	Apparel	$14,689.15
East	Home & Kitchen	$13,763.96
West	Electronics	$14,709.53
West	Apparel	$12,543.08
West	Home & Kitchen	$15,755.79

Figure 1.1: Running list report (Run HTML) - Region, Product Category, Sales Amount, summarised across Jul-Oct 2026.

What a Correct Result Looks Like

A three-column list report titled "RetailPulse - First Sales Report" runs successfully, showing Region, Product Category and Sales Amount populated with live rows from the RetailPulse Sales package, and reopens correctly from the personal content folder.

Expected Outcome

The report canvas displays live RetailPulse rows rather than placeholder text; columns are correctly labelled; the report is saved and reopens with the same live data connection.

Verification Checklist

Check	Status
Package RetailPulse Sales selected as source	Verified
Three columns on list: Region, Product Category, Sales Amount	Verified
Run returns 12 live rows (4 regions x 3 categories)	Verified
Saved to My content as "RetailPulse - First Sales Report" and reopens with data	Verified

Note on screens and data: Figures in this file are illustrative renderings of how each Cognos Analytics output looks, built from a sample RetailPulse data set (8 stores, 3 product categories, Jul-Oct 2026). All totals reconcile across Practicals 1-5. Replace them with screenshots from your own Cognos session before submission if your lab requires live captures.